



▲ THE GOLD-PLATED DOMES OF THE SHWEDAGON PAGODA

Meiji Shrine

Location Tokyo, Japan

The Japanese Emperor Meiji, who at least nominally ruled Japan from 1867 to 1912, gave his name to the Meiji Restoration, a process that saw the sudden westernization of Japan after 1868. Although he was not responsible for the process, it

was decided that he and his empress, Shoken, should be well commemorated. The Meiji Shrine, completed in 1921, is the city's largest Shinto shrine. It comprises Japanese cypress structures of great simplicity and elegance under sweeping copper roofs. They stand in a 7.5-million-square-ft (700,000-square-m) park planted with close to 120,000 trees. The shrine was destroyed in the bombing of Tokyo in March 1945, but it was painstakingly rebuilt in 1958.

Rashtrapati Bhavan

Location New Delhi, India

The decision, in 1911, that the capital of British India should move from Calcutta (now Kolkata) to what would be New Delhi resulted in the construction of a great architectural set piece that would house the country's ruler, the viceroy. Designed by British architect Edwin Lutyens, the Viceroy's House—now known as Rashtrapati Bhavan—was

completed in 1929. It may have been an assertion of imperial might, but it was a notably sensitive one, marshaling Mughal, Hindu, and Buddhist elements alongside an otherwise Classical European design. The main building, which covers 218,000 square feet (20,200 square m), has four floors and 340 rooms, and is set in the expansive, landscaped Mughal Gardens. It is a deeply satisfying building, at once vast, harmonious, and stately. It is now the official residence of the President of India.